

EPISODE 25 (SESSION 1)

A Kingdom of What?

PRIMARY TEXT: EXODUS 19

As we continue to wrestle with the Text, its original context, audience, and how that should impact Christians today, Leviticus seeks to inspire us to action. This book, these laws for the tabernacle priests and nation of Israel, is not written to us as modern, Western Christians—so then why, or how, can we be priests today? If the Holy Spirit now also resides in me—in you—what do we do with this responsibility?

The priests of the tabernacle were meant to be set apart from their community. To show the people how their God was different. How, as Jesus followers, yet not practicing Jews, do we set ourselves apart so the fierce love and passion and difference of God are seen and known? Maybe it has to do with the contrast of *showing* versus *telling*.

**What do we do
with this
responsibility?**

The chiasm's center in Leviticus is one of the most beautiful treasures of the Text. That our purpose is to remind people, and *show* them, that they are forgiven, loved. Their sins are gone. Atoned for. Washed away. That God's mercy is more powerful and greater than our understanding of salvation or sin or who is "in" or "out." We see the natural result of an intimate relationship with God are actions that make Him seen and known, not to have all the correct answers.

This is modeled and acted upon—mobile, just as the tabernacle in the desert was. God *shows* us time and time again the truth that His people—you—are right there with Him. No more self-deprecation needed. No more baggage packed with guilt and shame. No more pointing fingers.

There are so many metaphors and images in the Text and in our modern world that paint this life changing truth in our world for us.

God meeting Adam and Eve where they were at, creating their clothes.
Pointing His bow in the clouds toward Himself.
Walking through the blood path twice.
Carrying His people out of Egypt.
Meeting Israel under the chuppah and the creation of the tabernacle itself.

Or even more simply, He shows us through the rising of the sun each morning or the blooming of flowers each spring.

We show it.

How do we be a Kingdom of priests? We *show* it.

We put God on display. We help people navigate atonement so they may believe they are forgiven. We intercede and act on other's behalf, trying with all we are to have not one

left behind, left outside of the Kingdom of God. We give to those in need, making sure everyone has enough.

We grab onto God's unending mercy with one hand, holding tight, never letting go, and we reach out across the gap and clasp onto the rest of the world God still so dearly loves. We show with our actions and our tears. With all of our heart and soul and mind—to live out the freeing message of Leviticus and the world-changing commandment of Jesus—love the Lord your God with all your heart and soul and might, and love your neighbor as yourself.

**Pick an image of
God... and *show* it.**

When we're not sure where to start, what to say, or what to do, pick an image of God, of Jesus, of the Spirit—and *show* it.

The helping hand. The house of healing. The outstretched arms.
The ears that hear the cries. The manna in the wilderness. The peace in the chaos.
The calm in the storm. The fists kneading the bread. The hand wiping the tears.
The light shining in the darkness.

An image of God's very good creation, redeemed and beautiful in His sight, a partner in the Kingdom of God.

PRAYER

*Heavenly Father,
Thank you for never leaving us
in Egypt or the desert or even in days of plenty.
For being different—a God who loves His people
more than the power over them.
May we be a people who partner with You
each morning and evening.
Who put You on display, revealing Your heart.
Who point others to intimate relationship with You,
so everyone may know they are forgiven, loved.
Who stand in the gap, taking the outcast in one hand,
the other grasping tightly to Your mercy.
A people who see need and fill it
for the poor, the broken, the lost.
You are different.
You call us to be different.
May we choose to be different
as Your Kingdom of priests—always.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 25

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to meditate over from Leviticus? We may not have read the whole book in the episode, but be sure to read it! What part of this Text challenges you to dig deeper?



COMMUNITY

How does your community lean into the role of priesthood? How might you work on one or multiple areas of the priestly calling? Putting God on display, atonement, etc.?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who can you bring alongside you to model these attributes of priesthood—to help navigate their own atonement or intercede for? Who are you discipling to model the work of the priests and the purpose of the tabernacle in your life?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? The translation of this difficult Text to our modern world? The role of Christians as priests outside of practicing Jews? Past experiences with this book that make you skeptical or make it difficult to see the good news in these laws?



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Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We're just past the episode diving into what this idea of spiritual formation is all about! What spiritual practices or disciplines might you need to connect with God to put God on display and be a priest in His Kingdom? We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it.** How might the smallest practice fill you with more of Him? What practice could you refine, pick up again, or challenge yourself to try for the very first time? If you haven't yet, start by creating that space—He will fill it—and make the actions of a priest of the Kingdom of God be all the more natural and real.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future, and they need to experience God through people like you. **They need to see what it looks like firsthand to be part of this Kingdom of priests!** This isn't pressure to save their soul, it's the natural mobility of the Spirit working in our lives. Let God do the heavy lifting, pattern your life after His, and be on the lookout for those young people to show them who God truly is!*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Imagine how our world, our theology of work, might be different if we did so in the mindset of being part of the "priesthood." Living in intimacy with God is about how you put Him on display, in how you pursue and experience your 9–5, and how that changes you and the people you meet as God does the work of forgiveness and redemption. Does your physical work put you in a position to be a walking image of God's love, God's promise? Do you help others navigate their atonement, believing they're very good? Do you intercede on behalf of others or care for the outcast in the workplace? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can make an impact. **You are doing a sacred work—no matter where you are.***